

Comparing Three-Digit Numbers

Comparing three-digit numbers on a place-value chart, comparing numbers shown with base-ten blocks, ordering three numbers, and answering questions about real counts

How to compare. Write both numbers in a place-value chart, one digit per box. Then start at the **left** and compare one place at a time.

- Compare the hundreds first. The number with more hundreds is greater, no matter what the other digits are.
- Same hundreds? Compare the tens. Same tens? Compare the ones.
- A base-ten block picture counts the same way: 1 flat is one hundred, 1 rod is one ten, 1 small cube is one.
- $>$ means “is greater than” and $<$ means “is less than”. The point always aims at the smaller number.

1. The red bin holds 462 books. The blue bin holds 429 books. Write each number in the chart, then write $>$ or $<$ between them.

	hundreds	tens	ones
red bin			
blue bin			

462 _____ 429

Answer: _____

- 2.** Ella built a number with 3 flats, 5 rods, and 2 cubes. Ryan built a number with 3 flats, 2 rods, and 8 cubes.

Write Ella's number and Ryan's number. Then write $>$ or $<$ between them.

Ella: _____ Ryan: _____

Answer: _____

- 3.** Compare 508 and 580. Fill in the chart first, then write $>$ or $<$ between the numbers.

	hundreds	tens	ones
508			
580			

Which place decides the answer? Write it on your work space.

Answer: _____

- 4.** Oak School collected 615 cans of food. Pine School collected 651 cans of food. Which school collected more cans?

Write the two numbers with $>$ or $<$ between them, then write the name of the school that collected more.

Answer: _____

5. Put these three numbers in order from **least to greatest**: 473, 437, 743.

_____ , _____ , _____

Answer: _____

6. Sam built a number with 2 flats, 0 rods, and 9 cubes. Nina built a number with 1 flat, 9 rods, and 8 cubes.

Nina has more rods than Sam. Does that make Nina's number greater? Write both numbers, compare them with $>$ or $<$, and explain in one sentence.

Sam: _____ Nina: _____

Answer: _____

7. Compare 384 and 389.

	hundreds	tens	ones
384			
389			

384 _____ 389

Answer: _____

8. Maya's step counter showed 892 steps on Monday. Ben's step counter showed 928 steps on Monday.

Maya says she walked more because her number starts with a bigger tens digit. Is Maya right? Compare the two numbers with $>$ or $<$ and explain which place you looked at first.

Answer: _____

9. Put these three numbers in order from **greatest to least**: 605, 650, 560.

_____, _____, _____

Answer: _____

10. Challenge. A number has a 5 in the hundreds place and a 7 in the ones place. The tens digit is missing:

hundreds	tens	ones
5		7

The number must be greater than 547 and less than 587. Write the *smallest* number that works, and show it beats both tests.

Answer: _____